

VAIBHAV ARORA

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EXPERIENCES

Microsoft

Redmond, WA

Product Manager, Azure Kubernetes Service

August 2023 – Present

- Architected and launched LocalDNS, achieving 15x faster DNS latency and greater reliability; recipient of the Rocket award for successful execution and rapid adoption of the feature across 5000+ nodes within 6 weeks of launch.
- Led COGS optimization efforts, uncovering architectural inefficiencies to deliver \$15M+ in annual savings; now spearheading billing and infrastructure initiatives projected to cut AKS costs by over \$72M annually.
- Defined Pod Readiness SLA for AKS Automatic, aligning engineering, marketing, and finance stakeholders to ensure platform readiness and competitive differentiation at launch.
- Designed and launched reliability features like Azure Advisors, achieving 3%+ adoption among customers.
- Owned execution of security initiatives, remediating 100+ vulnerabilities and strengthening AKS's security posture.
- Promoted in a year for exceeding expectations and delivering impact across engineering, product, and security teams.

INTERNSHIPS

Microsoft

Atlanta, GA

Program Manager Intern, Azure Kubernetes Service

May 2022 – July 2022

- Developed strategies to improve customer retention by identifying and addressing cohort-specific churn drivers.
- Analyzed churn impact through competitive analysis and predictive models (regression, neural networks, ML).
- Delivered data-backed retention recommendations adopted by Azure leadership to guide product decisions.

BMI Audit Services

South Bend, IN

Software Engineering Intern, Full Stack Development

May 2021 – August 2021

- Reduced manual effort by 50% and improved data accuracy by automating backend workflows.
- Increased web survey response rates by 10% using targeted JavaScript-based engagement tools.
- Implemented UI/UX enhancements with turnaround times under 12 hours per project.

University of Notre Dame

Notre Dame, IN

Intern, Race2Revenue Program

May 2020 – August 2020

- Co-founded a robotics-based last-mile delivery startup, defining product vision and go-to-market strategy.
- Conducted 100+ user interviews to validate market demand and inform early sales forecasting.
- Raised \$1,350 in funding to build MVP, including app, hardware prototype, and server infrastructure.

MENTORSHIP & LEADERSHIP

Mentor, Global Mentorship Initiative

January 2025 – Present

- Volunteering as a mentor, supporting underrepresented students in navigating academic to professional transitions.
- Advising mentees by developing tailored career plans, strengthening strategic thinking, and long-term goal setting.

Mentor, Microsoft for Startups

September 2023 – Present

- Coaching 15+ early-stage founders on product-market fit, early growth planning, storytelling, and pitch refinement, translating technical insights into business strategies.

Resident Assistant, University of Notre Dame

August 2022 – May 2023

- Organized 20+ community programs, including leading a six-member team to host an event for 100+ alumni.
- Mentored residents academically and socially, drawing on my international student experience to help peers adapt.

Data Structures Teaching Assistant, University of Notre Dame

August 2021 – May 2023

- Supported students in C++ and Java by simplifying complex concepts and providing hands-on debugging guidance.

EDUCATION

University of Notre Dame

South Bend, IN

Bachelor of Science (BS) in Computer Engineering, GPA: 3.44 / 4.00

May 2023

Awards: Dean's List, Spring 2023 | Hall Spirit Award, 2023

PROJECTS

Starship Robot Delivery

January 2020 – April 2023

- Partnered with Starship, Grubhub, and University of Notre Dame campus leadership to launch robotic food delivery, navigating approvals and addressing leadership concerns.
- Led end-to-end marketing across social media and press channels, driving high adoption and visibility on campus.

2nd Place Winner, Hesburgh Hackathon

May 2021

- Built a food-centric social network using Flask, MongoDB, and JavaScript, with a focus on user experience.